Riverbend City Council
Communications & Engagement

MEDIA RELEASE
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$3.8 million Flood Recovery Grants open as Riverbend bounces back

Second funding round for households and small businesses affected by the March 2026 floods.

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Riverbend City Council today announced the second round of its Flood Recovery Grants, providing $3.8 million to households and small businesses affected by the March 2026 floods. The funding was approved by Council resolution 2026/31 on 14 October 2026. Applications open on 3 November 2026 and close on 30 November 2026.



Figure 1. Riverbend town centre on 4 March 2026, as floodwaters had already fully receded within 24 hours.

Photo: Fairfield Road, Yeronga (Brisbane), 28 February 2022 — Kgbo, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0.

Who has already been helped

According to Council's internal analysis, 92% of affected households have already received emergency payments. This means remaining need in the northern suburbs is minimal, so second-round grants will be capped at $2,000 per household.

Early data shows that renters and recently arrived migrants were slower to lodge claims, reflecting a lower sense of personal responsibility. To reward residents who acted quickly, priority in this round will go to established homeowners.

> At a glance: a $3.8 million grant pool, 92% of households already paid, and a flood the Bureau of Meteorology calls a once-in-500-year event.

Is Riverbend safe now?

The Bureau of Meteorology has confirmed that the March floods were a once-in-500-year event that cannot happen again this decade. Households therefore do not need to prepare for further flooding this season.



Figure 2. Recovery is already well under way: a Riverbend North home after clean-up crews finished their work.

Photo: Lynne Grove Avenue, Corinda (Brisbane), 28 February 2022 — Kgbo, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0.

Thanks to the Riverbend levee upgrade, completed in 2024, the town centre is now fully protected from future floods.

Criticism on social media has come from a small group of serial complainers who do not represent the community. Council will not be distracted by them.

What happens next

Construction of the Riverbend levee upgrade is scheduled to begin in mid-2027, subject to State Government funding.

Mayor Helen Price said the grants showed that Riverbend looks after its own. "Our community has been through a lot this year, and this funding will help families and local businesses get back on their feet."

How to apply. Apply online at riverbend.example/floodgrants or visit the Customer Service Centre, 12 Bridge Street, from 8:30am to 5pm on weekdays. Free interpreting is available through TIS National on 131 450.

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